ENG-0006 Incident Postmortem: INC-091

Impact

The incident INC-091 affected the auth-gateway system, which is part of Project Fathom. Given its criticality level as medium, the system's unavailability or degraded performance potentially impacted user authentication processes across multiple services. The resolution of this incident took approximately 3.5 hours, during which time users may have experienced login disruptions or delays. The prompt resolution minimized the overall operational impact, but the incident underscores the importance of rigorous change management procedures for systems integral to our infrastructure.

Timeline

- **Incident Reported**: The incident was reported by Gina Moore, Head of Sales, on 2025-05-27.
- **On-Call Engineer Activation**: Alyssa Long, Product Manager and on-call engineer for auth-gateway, was alerted and responded promptly.
- **Detection and Diagnosis**: Initial diagnosis indicated a configuration change as the root cause.
- **Resolution**: The team implemented corrective measures, restoring full system functionality within 3.5 hours.
- **Post-Resolution**: System stability was confirmed, and incident closure procedures were completed.

Root Cause

The root cause of INC-091 was identified as a configuration change within the auth-gateway system. This change was likely introduced during routine updates or maintenance activities associated with Project Fathom, which was completed prior to the incident. The configuration change was not adequately tested or validated before deployment, leading to system disruption.

Action Items

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Review and reinforce change management procedures for auth-gateway	Project Lead (E-160)	2025-06-10	Ensure all configuration changes undergo thorough testing and approval.
Implement additional monitoring and alerting for configuration deviations	DevOps Team	2025-06-15	Enhance early detection capabilities to prevent similar incidents.
Conduct a post-incident review with all relevant stakeholders	Project Fathom team	2025-06-12	Share lessons learned and update protocols accordingly.

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Provide refresher training on change procedures for technical staff	HR and Training Department	2025-06-20	Minimize human error during deployment processes.

Conclusion

The incident INC-091 underscores the critical importance of strict adherence to change management protocols, especially for systems like auth-gateway that are vital to operational continuity. Alyssa Long responded swiftly as the on-call engineer, and the resolution time of 3.5 hours was within acceptable limits given the circumstances. Moving forward, the outlined action items aim to mitigate the risk of recurrence and improve system resilience. The Project Fathom team remains committed to continuous improvement and operational excellence.